

Game Design Report

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1. Summary

The title of the game is 'Claybound', the game consists of mainly two different genres:

- Rogelite
- Role Playing Game (RPG)

1.1. Synopsis

Claybound is a rougelite in which the player takes control of a clay like creation called a homunculus brought to life by a lazy and irresponsible wizard. Abandoned in a dungeon with nothing but a basic weapon, the player must battle through hordes of enemies, uncover new weapons and proceed to the next floor of the dungeon, all while the dungeon grows increasingly more difficult as time ticks by. Items can be found in boxes scattered around however acquiring them requires rolling a dice, with the outcomes being determined by one of four stats. The overarching goal is to clean up the wizards mess and survive long enough.

1.2. Target Audience

The game will be set at PEGI 12 due it containing mild violence, some horror elements and crude humour, however the game will be able to be enjoyed by a wide variety of age ranges and players alike. The primary audience will be players age 16 - 25 who are already fans of similar roguelikes such as Risk Of Rain 2 (CITE!), Hades (CITE!) or Vampire Survivors. This is due to them already understanding run based progression and item building already, meaning the core game loop does not need explaining, this audience will most likely value replayability of the story elements

The secondary audience will be fans of narrative driven RPG's such as Baldurs Gate 3 or Disco elysium who enjoy the stat expression. This audience most likely wont be too familiar with roguelikes but are drawn in by humour, world building and the fact their choices have personality.

1.3. Game Experience

There are a variety of things I would like the player to feel but the main thing would be Grit, as just like the homunculus you are playing you must never give up and keep trying to escape this dungeon you have been forced into

1.4. MoSCoW

Must Have	Should Have	Could Have	Won't Have
Basic Movement Mechanics	Health & Combat System	Multiple Levels	High Fidelity Textures & Assets
Four-Stat System (MIGHT, FINESSE, WEIRD, GAB)	Variety of Weapons	Sound System	Self-Made 3D Assets
Dice Roll Chest Mechanic	Enemy NPCs with Cone Detection AI	NPC Scheduling & Routines	Visual Novel Story Implementation
Item Pickup & Stat Modification	Basic Boss Encounter	Stat-Specific NPC Interactions	Multiplayer
Level Completion Condition	Tetris-Style Inventory	Main Menu with Lore	Procedurally Generated Levels
Timer & Difficulty Scaling	Basic Animation		
NPCs with Basic AI	Retro Shader Applied to Environment		
Menus & Basic UI			
A Single Fully Developed Level			

Table 1: MoSCoW Prioritisation – Claybound

2. Background

2.1. *Risk Of Rain 2 (2020)*

See Figure 1 in the appendix. *Risk of Rain 2 (CITE!)* is a third-person roguelite in which the player controls a survivor that battles through increasingly dangerous worlds, escaping through a portal whilst managing a timer that keeps increasing the difficulty. Claybound draws direct inspiration from this structure, adopting the timer based difficulty and run based item progression yet grounding these mechanics in a more narrative, character driven world.

2.2. *Megabonk (2025)*

Megabonk(CITE!) is a third person roguelite survival game similar to Risk of Rain 2 in which the player navigates 3D maps, fighting waves of enemies and bosses whilst their weapons attack automatically. This game proved the auto attacking 'bullet heaven' formula crated by Vampire Survivors could successfully be translated into a 3D space. Claybound draws two key influences from *Megabonk*:

- Auto attacking weapon system - allows the player to focus more on movement rather than combat inputs
- Retro low-poly aesthetic



Figure 1: Megabonk Retro Style graphics

3. Specification

3.1. Game Story

Claybound is set in the forgotten dungeon of a wizard unnamed, this chaotic basement is full of remnants of failed experiments, escaped creatures and magical neglect. Rather than clean it himself, the wizard decides to delegate this task. Using a hastily put together spell, he created a clay humanoid called a homunculus and drop it into his dungeon with nothing but a basic weapon and vague instructions to sort everything out.

The homunculus has no memory, no name and no choice. Armed with instinct and a range of scavenged items, the player must fight through waves of the dungeons inhabitants, locate the portal to the next floor and defeat whatever the wizard left locked in the basement.

3.2. Game aesthetics

The overall aesthetic of the game is darkly comedic, the homunculus is an unwilling protagonist thrust into a dangerous situation, and the world reflects this. Enemies include failed experiments and escaped subjects. The story is mainly told environmentally rather than through cutscenes, thus rewarding players who interact through the world with the dice roll system.

3.3. Game content

3.4. Game mechanics

3.5. Game technology

4. Prototype

5. Conclusion

References

A. Appendix

A.1. System Architecture